

Timing Resolution: EJ-204 vs EJ-230 on a Plastic Scintillator Bar — TIR-only Configuration

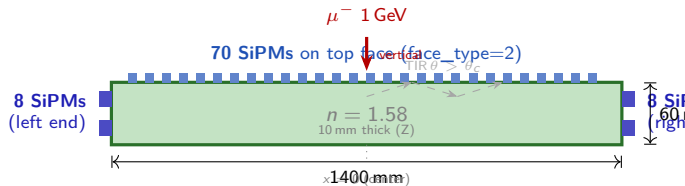
Geant4 11.4 MT Simulation — feat/ej204-bar-tir-only & feat/ej230-bar-tir-only

R. Rios

Simulated using ej200 framework (SSLG4)

August 15, 2026

Detector Geometry — EJ-204/EJ-230 Scintillator Bar



XY side view (not to scale in Y)

Bar Geometry

Shape	Rectangular bar
Length	1400 mm
Height	60 mm
Width	10 mm
Refractive index	$n = 1.58$
TIR angle	$\theta_c = 39.3^\circ$

Readout

End SiPMs	8 per end, 2 ends
Top SiPMs	70 (face_type=2)
Total	86 SiPMs
Coupling	polished, direct

Surface (TIR-only)

Type	Polished, dielectric
------	----------------------

Two Scintillators Compared

EJ-204 (OPSC-101)

Decay time	2.1 ns
Rise time	0.5 ns
Light yield	10 000 ph/MeV
Att. length	160 cm
Peak λ	408 nm

Branch: feat/ej204-bar-tir-only

EJ-230 (OPSC-106)

Decay time	1.5 ns
Rise time	0.5 ns
Light yield	9200 ph/MeV
Att. length	120 cm
Peak λ	391 nm

Branch: feat/ej230-bar-tir-only

Simulation Parameters (identical for both)

Particle	Energy	Direction	Position	Statistics
μ^-	1 GeV	vertical ($-Y$)	$x = 0$ (bar centre)	5000 events

GROUPVEL aliasing fix applied: world air set to $v_g = c/1.58$. SiPM electronics jitter: $\sigma_{\text{jitter}} = 0$ (intrinsic photon limit).
Readout mode: EndTop (end + top SiPMs simultaneously active).

Photon Yield per Event — Top vs. End SiPMs

Mean $\langle N_{pe} \rangle$ per event

SiPM group	EJ-204	EJ-230
Top SiPMs (70, face_type=2)	117.1	106.2
Left end (8, face_type=0)	0.39	~ 0.4
Right end (8, face_type=1)	0.38	~ 0.4
Top / End ratio	$\sim 300\times$	

Key result: end SiPMs are blind

Without Mylar/Vikuiti reflector, photons must travel 700 mm to reach the end SiPMs. Each lateral bounce has a chance of escaping TIR ($\theta < 39.3^\circ$ from normal $\rightarrow$ Fresnel loss). After ~ 700 mm of propagation:

- Bulk absorption: $e^{-700/1600} \approx 0.64$
- Accumulated TIR escape losses $\rightarrow$ only ~ 0.4 ph reach each end

Top SiPMs are the only viable readout for TIR-only timing.

Light yield ratio: $\text{EJ-204}/\text{EJ-230} = 117.1/106.2 = 1.10$, consistent with light-yield ratio $10000/9200 = 1.087$ from material tables.

Timing Resolution Setup — k -th Photon Order Statistics

Method

- 1 Per event: sort all photon arrival times on the **top SiPMs** (70 SiPMs combined).
- 2 Extract $t_{(k)}$ = k -th earliest arrival time.
- 3 Build histogram of $t_{(k)}$ across all 5000 events.
- 4 Fit Gaussian to the core ($\pm 2\sigma_{68\%}$ range) — robust against the right-skew of order statistics.
- 5 $\sigma(k)$ = Gaussian width = timing resolution when triggering on the k -th photon.

Why $\sigma(k)$ is expected to be monotonically increasing

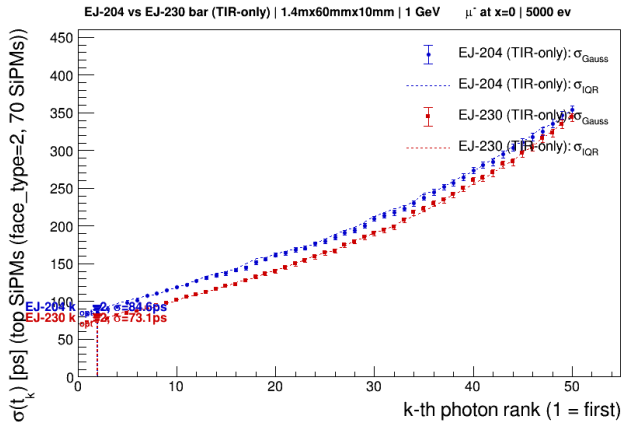
$k = 1 \Rightarrow$ fastest photon; dominated by transit geometry
 $k \uparrow \Rightarrow$ deeper into scintillation time dist. $\rightarrow$ wider σ
No dip $\Rightarrow$ unlike cylinder: no direct/reflected photon cross-over

Timing components at top SiPMs

- 1 **Emission time:** exponential τ_{decay}
(dominant at 2.1 ns / 1.5 ns)
- 2 **Transit time:** ~ 30 mm mean vertical path $\rightarrow \sigma_{\text{tr}} \approx 30$ ps spread
- 3 **TIR path variance:** photons bouncing laterally add a few ps of extra spread

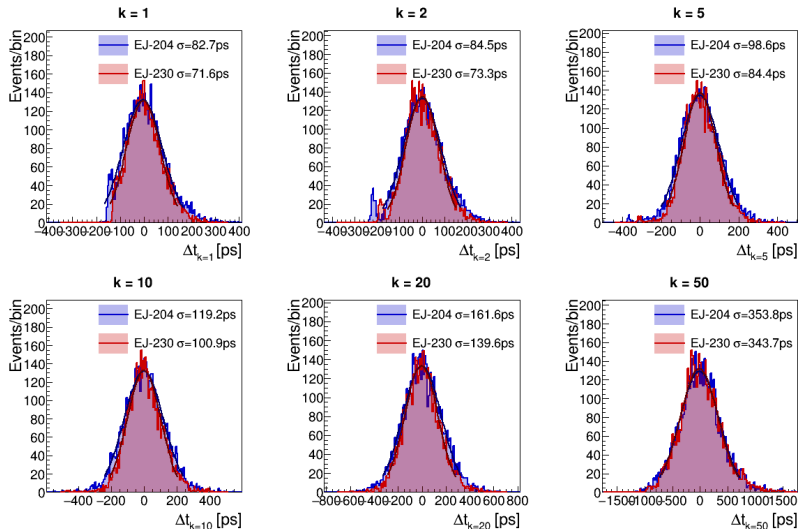
Config	$\langle N_{\text{pe}} \rangle$ top
EJ-204	117
EJ-230	106

$\sigma(k)$ vs k — Timing Resolution Curves



Blue (EJ-204): σ_{Gauss} (filled circles) and σ_{IQR} (dashed). **Red (EJ-230):** same estimators. Both curves rise monotonically: $k_{\text{opt}} = 2$ for both configurations. EJ-230 is consistently $\sim 15\%$ better across all k values.

$t_{(k)}$ Distributions — Gaussian Fits (top SiPMs)



Each panel: $\Delta t_k = t_{(k)} - \text{median}(t_{(k)})$ across 5000 events. Solid curve: EJ-204 (blue); dashed: EJ-230 (red). The

Timing Resolution — Numerical Summary

k	$\sigma_{\text{EJ-204}}$ [ps]	$\sigma_{\text{EJ-230}}$ [ps]	ratio	Notes
1	82.7	71.6	1.155	geometric floor
2 (k_{opt})	84.5	73.1	1.153	optimal threshold
5	98.6	84.4	1.169	scintillation onset
10	119.2	100.9	1.181	
20	161.6	139.6	1.157	
50	353.8	343.7	1.029	deep exponential tail

Key result

$\sigma_{\text{opt}} \approx 83$ ps (EJ-204) and 73 ps (EJ-230) in the zero-jitter limit. Both reach their optimum at $k_{\text{opt}} = 2$. These values are dominated by scintillation decay time, not geometric spread.

EJ-230 advantage

EJ-230 gives $\sim 15\%$ better timing resolution at $k \leq 20$. Advantage disappears at $k = 50$ (ratio $\rightarrow 1.03$): both sample deep into the exponential tail where the decay time difference matters less per extra photon.

Physics Interpretation

Why $\sigma(k)$ is monotonically increasing

In the cylinder (EJ-228), $\sigma(k)$ shows a **dip** at $k \approx 8$: at that threshold, direct-path photons dominate over once-reflected ones, minimising geometric path spread.

In the bar (top SiPMs), **no such dip occurs**:

- Muon track is only 60 mm tall; all photons reaching the top face travel a similar path length ($\sigma_{tr} \sim 30$ ps)
- The dominant jitter is from the scintillation decay time ($\tau_{decay} = 2.1$ ns or 1.5 ns) — much larger than geometry
- Each extra photon arrives later on the exponential decay: $\sigma(k)$ can only grow

Why EJ-230 is $\sim 15\%$ better

For order statistics of an exponential distribution, $\sigma(k) \propto \tau_{decay}$. Naively:

$$\frac{\sigma_{EJ-204}}{\sigma_{EJ-230}} \approx \sqrt{\frac{\tau_{204}}{\tau_{230}}} = \sqrt{\frac{2.1}{1.5}} = 1.18$$

Observed ratio = 1.15–1.18 across all $k \leq 20$.

The $\sqrt{\tau}$ scaling (rather than τ) arises because N_{pe} is also slightly higher for EJ-204 ($\langle N \rangle = 117$ vs 106, ratio 1.10), partially offsetting the decay-time disadvantage.

Conclusion: for top-SiPM timing of a TIR-only bar, the scintillation decay time is the dominant figure of merit, not light yield or reflector quality.

Summary & Conclusions

1. A $1400\text{ mm} \times 60\text{ mm} \times 10\text{ mm}$ plastic scintillator bar was simulated in Geant4 11.4 MT with **TIR-only** surfaces (no Mylar / Vikuiti reflector) for two scintillator materials: **EJ-204** and **EJ-230**. Vertical 1 GeV muons at bar centre ($x = 0$), 5000 events each.
2. **End SiPMs are essentially blind** in TIR-only: $\langle N_{pe} \rangle \approx 0.4$ per event vs. 117 at the top SiPMs. The 700 mm path to each end combined with Fresnel losses at lateral faces eliminates the end-SiPM signal.
3. For the **top SiPMs**, the $\sigma(k)$ curve is **monotonically increasing**: $k_{opt} = 2$ for both scintillators. The cylinder's $k_{opt} \approx 8$ dip is absent because scintillation decay time dominates over geometric path-length spread.
4. **EJ-230 gives $\sim 15\%$ better timing resolution** across all relevant k values: $\sigma_{opt} = 73\text{ ps}$ vs. 84 ps for EJ-204. The improvement scales as $\sqrt{\tau_{204}/\tau_{230}} = 1.18$, consistent with observation (ratio 1.15–1.18).
5. In the ideal (zero electronics jitter) limit, top-SiPM timing of a TIR-only bar at centre is limited to $\sim 70\text{--}85\text{ ps}$. Adding Vikuiti/Mylar would not improve this (it affects end SiPMs, not top).

Appendix: Simulation Parameters

Parameter	Value	Notes
Geant4 version	11.4.0 (MT)	24 threads
Framework	SSLG4	
Events	5000 per config	
Physics list	FTFP_BERT + optical	
Optical model	Unified (G4)	
GROUPVEL fix	$v_g = c/1.58$ in air	Prevents aliasing bug
Scintillation rise	0.5 ns	Both scintillators
Readout mode	EndTop	End + top SiPMs
SiPM jitter	0 (intrinsic limit)	
TIR surface	Polished, dielectric/dielectric	No REFLECTIVITY property
θ_c	39.3°	$\arcsin(1/1.58)$
Muon position	$x = 0$ (bar centre)	700 mm from each end

Repository: github.com/dowiyogo/ej200

Branches: `feat/ej204-bar-tir-only` (EJ-204) | `feat/ej230-bar-tir-only` (EJ-230)

Analysis script: `analysis/bar_timing_resolution.cxx`